NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • C1250–C1500

Medicine in Medieval Britain, c1250–c1500

c1250–c1500: Ideas on Causes, Prevention, Treatment, Medical Care & The Black Death



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • C.1350 MS 13076 • FOLIO 24V

Omne Bonum: Clerics Ministering to Plague Victims with Buboes

James le Palmer (fl. 1360–1375) • Fourteenth-century illuminated manuscript showing two plague sufferers bearing bubonic sores in bed while priests administer last rites and prayer.

PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE THE BRITISH LIBRARY MANUSCRIPT COLLECTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 11 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Ideas About the Cause of Disease and Illness

- Supernatural and religious explanations of the cause of disease.
- Rational explanations: the Theory of the Four Humours and the miasma theory; the continuing influence in England of Galen.

2 Approaches to Prevention and Treatment

- Approaches to prevention and treatment, and their connection with ideas about disease and illness: religious actions, bloodletting and purging, purifying the air.
- Medical training and traditional approaches to treatment and care for the sick: the role of the physician, apothecary and barber surgeon; the role of hospitals, care within the community and at home, including the use of herbal remedies.

3 Case Study

- Dealing with the Black Death, 1348–49; approaches to treatment and attempts to prevent its spread.

Living Timeline • Part 1: Medieval Ideas & Medical Hierarchy (c1250–c1350)

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

c. 1250 • The Church & The Monopoly on Medical Learning

Key Topic 1.1

The Catholic Church controls all English universities (Oxford, Cambridge) and hospital foundations. Monks hand-copy medical manuscripts in scriptoria, preserving Galen's anatomical writings because his teleological view—that the body had a single divine Creator—aligned with Christian dogma.

1277 • The Imprisonment of Roger Bacon

Key Topic 1.1

Franciscan friar and Oxford scholar Roger Bacon is imprisoned by church leaders for heresy after writing that physicians should conduct original scientific experiments rather than blindly copying Galen. This imprisonment effectively halts independent anatomical inquiry for over two centuries.

c. 1300 • The Diagnostic Tools: Matula Flasks & The Zodiac Man

Key Topic 1.2

Physicians practice uroscopy using glass matula flasks, comparing urine colour, density, and smell against 20-shade charts to diagnose humoral imbalance. They carry Vademecum pocketbooks containing the Zodiac Man to determine safe planetary alignments for phlebotomy (bloodletting).

c. 1320 • The Medical Hierarchy: Physicians, Barber-Surgeons & Apothecaries

Key Topic 1.4

A rigid division of medical labour establishes in England. Fewer than 100 elite university-trained physicians diagnose wealthy nobility. Town apothecaries mix theriac and herbal compounds, while lower-status barber-surgeons perform tooth-pulling, wound-cautery, and bloodletting.

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

c. 1350 • Monastic Hospitals: The Era of 'Care Not Cure'

Key Topic 1.4

Over 1,200 hospitals run by monks and nuns operate in England (e.g. St Bartholomew's, 1123). Patients receive clean bedding, warmth, food, and continuous prayer facing a chapel altar. Zero surgery or medical cure is attempted; lepers and plague victims are strictly barred.

1345 • The Great Planetary Conjunction in Aquarius

Key Topic 1.5

In March 1345, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn align in Aquarius. University of Paris physicians state this celestial conjunction drew up poisonous vapours from the earth, corrupting the air with deadly miasma, preparing Europe for the Black Death.

1348 • The Black Death Reaches Melcombe Regis, Dorset

Key Topic 1.5

In June 1348, the pestilence arrives on trade ships carrying black rats and fleas. The dual epidemic—bubonic plague (flea bites, agonizing buboes) and pneumonic plague (airborne coughing droplets)—kills 30–50% of England's population within 18 months.

1349 • King Edward III's Cleanliness Order & East Smithfield Mass Pits

Key Topic 1.5

Alarmed by rotting waste and stench, Edward III orders London streets cleared of dung to remove miasma. Churchyards overflow; emergency mass burial trenches are dug outside city walls at East Smithfield to bury hundreds of corpses daily.

Why did the Catholic Church dominate medieval explanations of disease?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • How did church scriptoria prevent new medical ideas from spreading?

- Church scriptoria monopoly
- Latin manuscript copying
- Roger Bacon imprisoned (1277)

2 c1280 • Why was leprosy viewed as visible proof of divine judgment?

- Divine punishment for sin
- Biblical leprosy stigma
- Lazar houses isolation

3 1345 • How did the Church reconcile astrology with Christian doctrine?

- 1345 planetary conjunction
- Mars, Jupiter & Saturn
- Zodiac calendar almanacs

4 c1350 • Why did sick people turn to pilgrimage shrines rather than doctors?

- Shrines & holy relics
- Pilgrimage prayers
- Sale of indulgences

5 c1400 • Why did church enforcement of Galen prevent medical progress?

- Galen theological fit
- Dissection bans enforced
- Heresy excommunication threat

If you develop a fever in 1300, church logic dictates you definitely committed a sin last Tuesday. Time to buy a pilgrimage badge!

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why the Catholic Church had such a major influence on ideas about the causes of disease in the period c1250–c1500. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Monastic scriptoria and book-copying** | **The imprisonment of Roger Bacon (1277)** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In the drawing box, sketch a monk copying Galen's medical book in a scriptorium. Add two speech bubbles explaining why the Church banned new medical experiments and imprisoned Roger Bacon in 1277. **[ ] Done**

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS

Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of disease in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) were similar to ideas in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Why did the Theory of the Four Humours dominate rational medicine for centuries?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c460 BC • How did Hippocrates separate medicine from superstition?

- Hippocratic clinical method
- Rejection of gods
- Hippocratic Oath ethics

2 c1250 • Why did humoral theory seem logical to medieval people?

- Four bodily humours
- Blood, phlegm & biles
- Seasonal balance system

3 c1280 • How did the Theory of Opposites provide practical treatment rules?

- Galen Theory of Opposites
- Contraries cure contraries
- Animal dissection errors

4 c1300 • Why did uroscopy give physicians great diagnostic authority?

- Uroscopy urine flask (matula)
- Urine diagnostic wheel
- Zodiac Man alignment

5 c1350 • Why did rational physicians link bad smells directly to epidemics?

- Miasma theory (bad air)
- Cesspool stench fears
- Unbalanced bodily fluids

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why the Theory of the Four Humours remained the dominant rational explanation of disease throughout the period c1250–c1500. [12 marks]

Stimulus: Galen's Theory of Opposites | The diagnostic matula (uroscopy) *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In the drawing box, sketch a four-part diagram of the Four Humours (Blood, Phlegm, Yellow Bile, Black Bile) showing their seasons and qualities. Annotate Galen's Theory of Opposites alongside a flask of urine. [ ] Done

Sniffing urine, tasting urine, holding urine up to the window. 14th-century diagnostics was 90% liquid inspection and 10% guessing.

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS] SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS

Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of disease in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) were different from ideas in the Modern period (c1900–present). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid difference, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

How did medieval people attempt to treat and prevent disease, and why did rational and religious methods coexist?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • Why did ordinary people consider prayer more vital than medicine?

- Penance & fasting
- Chanted Latin prayers
- Flagellant whipping processions

2 c1300 • Why was bloodletting the most universal physical treatment?

- Phlebotomy vein incision
- Iron fleams & leeches
- Cupping & pewter bowls

3 c1320 • How was purging believed to restore bodily equilibrium?

- Emetics (black hellebore)
- Laxatives & clysters
- Humoural fluid evacuation

4 c1350 • Why did herbal recipes remain popular across all social classes?

- Herbal Materia Medica
- Theriac (70 ingredients)
- Local apothecaries remedies

5 c1400 • How did wealthy barons attempt to prevent sickness before it struck?

- Regimen Sanitatis rules
- Sweet pomander scents
- Lavender & burning tar

Bleeding, purging, boiling vinegar, and swallowing crushed emeralds. If the disease didn't kill you, the apothecary's bill definitely would.

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why bloodletting and purging remained the most common medical treatments throughout the period c1250–c1500. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Phlebotomy (bloodletting by fleam or leeches)** **The Regimen Sanitatis** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In the drawing box, sketch a barber-surgeon using a fleam and pewter bleeding bowl, alongside a flagellant whip. Label how one treated the body and the other treated the soul. **[ ] Done**

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** **SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS**

Explain one way in which approaches to preventing disease in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) were similar to approaches in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Who provided medical care in medieval England, and why did hospitals focus on care rather than cure?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • Why were university physicians accessible only to the ultra-wealthy?

- University-trained physicians
- Latin texts & star charts
- High diagnostic fees

2 c1300 • How did apothecaries provide accessible medicines to townspeople?

- Apothecary guild trade
- Herbal preparations sold
- Cheaper urban access

3 c1320 • Why were barber-surgeons viewed as lower-status craftsmen?

- Barber-surgeon guild
- Bloodletting & tooth pulling
- Cauterisation & amputation

4 c1350 • Why did monastic hospitals deliberately avoid medical treatment?

- Monastic charity hospitals
- Care not cure philosophy
- Bed rest & prayer

5 c1400 • Why did the vast majority of sick people rely on female family members?

- Domestic women healers
- Local herb gardening
- Midwifery & home care

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why hospital care in medieval England was based on the concept of 'care rather than cure' in the period c1250–c1500. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Monastic rules and religious charity** | **The exclusion of infectious diseases (lepers and plague victims)** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In the drawing box, sketch the interior of a monastic hospital ward showing rows of beds facing a chapel altar. Annotate why monks prioritized prayer over medical surgery. **[ ] Done**

Barber-surgeons: short back and sides, pull out a molar, lance a boil, amputate a leg. Multi-tasking at its finest and bloodiest.

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS]** **SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS**

Explain one way in which the work of hospitals in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) was different from hospitals in the nineteenth century. [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid difference, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Why did medieval society fail to halt the devastating mortality of the Black Death?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 June 1348 • How did trade routes unwittingly bring the plague to England?

- Melcombe Regis port (1348)
- Yersinia pestis bacteria
- Black rats & fleas

2 Autumn 1348 • Why was the pneumonic strain far deadlier than the bubonic form?

- Bubonic groin swellings (buboes)
- Pneumonic bloody coughing
- Mortality in three days

3 Winter 1348 • Why were medical treatments completely useless against the plague?

- Divine wrath & miasma
- Lancing buboes & live hens
- Bleeding & crushed emeralds

4 1349 • How did belief in miasma shape royal prevention orders?

- Quarantine isolation rules
- Cleaning town butchery waste
- Street fire smoke barriers

5 1349–1350 • Why did the Black Death trigger a long-term social and economic crisis?

- Mass burial trenches
- Third to half population lost
- Labour shortage & wage rises

In 1348, people blamed God, the planets, bad smells, and foreigners. The actual culprits—fleas on black rats—went completely unnoticed.

Question 5/6: Thematic Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

'The main reason why so many people died during the Black Death (1348–49) was because governments had no effective way of preventing disease.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Stimulus: **King Edward III's cleanliness order (1349)** | **Belief in miasma and supernatural causes** | *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.5). In the drawing box, sketch the arrival of a trading cog at Melcombe Regis carrying rats and fleas, alongside an emergency mass burial pit at East Smithfield. **[ ] Done**

Continue your response to Question 5/6 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS

Explain one way in which responses to the Black Death (1348–49) were similar to responses to the Great Plague of London (1665). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

KEY TOPIC 1 NOTES & EXAMINATION STRATEGY

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 1: Medicine in Britain, c1250–present • Medieval Britain (c1250–c1500)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / SPECIFICATION FOCUS	DO NOW (10M)	Q3 SIM/DIFF (4M)	Q4/5 EXTENDED	LESSON TOTAL
1	**KT1.1: Supernatural & Religious Explanations of Disease** *"Why did the Catholic Church dominate medieval explanations of disease?"*	/ 10	/ 4	Q4 Explain: / 12	/ 26
2	**KT1.2: Rational Explanations: Hippocrates, Galen & The Four Humours** *"Why did the Theory of the Four Humours dominate rational medicine for centuries?"*	/ 10	/ 4	Q4 Explain: / 12	/ 26
3	**KT1.3: Approaches to Prevention & Treatment: Rituals, Bleeding & Purging** *"How did medieval people attempt to treat and prevent disease, and why did rational and religious methods coexist?"*	/ 10	/ 4	Q4 Explain: / 12	/ 26
4	**KT1.4: Medical Care Providers & Monastic Hospitals: 'Care Not Cure'** *"Who provided medical care in medieval England, and why did hospitals focus on care rather than cure?"*	/ 10	/ 4	Q4 Explain: / 12	/ 26
5	**KT1.5: Case Study: Dealing with the Black Death (1348–1349)** *"Why did medieval society fail to halt the devastating mortality of the Black Death?"*	/ 10	/ 4	Q5/6 Essay: / 20	/ 34
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 50**	**Q3: / 20**	**Ext: / 68**	**/ 138**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 1.1	KT 1.2	KT 1.3	KT 1.4	KT 1.5
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**

Retain this student assessment record for parent consultations and GCSE revision monitoring.